



RIGHTSIZE. RIGHT SUPPORT. **RIGHT** *for* **STUDENTS.**

A family guide to the proposed school changes

Every school is a community. A school change can affect friendships, routines, programs, and a family's sense of belonging. This guide explains what is proposed and why.

Scenarios A and B are proposals, not final decisions. "No changes proposed" means these options do not include a change for that school.

Each school has a snapshot and a box explaining the reasons for the proposal. The next page shows enrollment estimates, programs, student groups, and maps. Estimates cover 2027-28 through 2031-32. They are not current student counts.

The possible benefits are goals. A larger school does not automatically get a full-time librarian, certain staff, or specific programs. Those details depend on the district's staffing rules, budget, and plans for making the changes.

A school or program move does not determine where an individual student receiving special education services will go. Families and school teams would need to plan each student's services and support.

The school details, numbers, and maps come from PPS school profiles. This guide explains that information in simpler language.

Words you may see in this guide

No changes

What is expected if the district keeps the current schools and programs.

Option A / Option B

The two scenarios. "A and B" means the same information applies to both.

School boundary

The area used to assign students to a neighborhood school based on where they live.

School communities joining

Students from two or more schools would come together. The proposal says which school building would close.

Programs joining

A program would come together at one school or move to another school.

DLI

Dual Language Immersion: learning in English and another language.

School size goal

More than 360 students for K-5 schools; more than 500 for K-8 or middle schools; more than 1,100 for high schools. These are planning goals, not ratings of school quality.

Space use goal

The district aims to use 70%-100% of a school's available room for students. A "No" can mean the school is below or above that range.

Title I

Federal money that supports schools serving students from low-income households. The guide shows the expected designation.

IEP

An Individualized Education Program: a written plan for a student's special education services and support.

Choice program

A program with a special focus, such as arts or science. It may serve families beyond a neighborhood school boundary.

Student groups

Groups can overlap. Do not add the percentages together.

**You may notice slight differences in student numbers and/or demographics in schools that don't experience change because a focus option school has changed and we assume that students return to their neighborhood school.*

JAMES JOHN

School proposal | Options A and B

SCHOOL SNAPSHOT	DETAILS
Current program	K-5 neighborhood/language immersion
Expected enrollment with no changes	359 in 2027-28; 352 in 2031-32
District school size goal	More than 360 students
Students living within 1 mile	70.9%
Building notes	Repair needs are described below.

WHY IS PPS CONSIDERING THIS?

Building layout constraints: James John faces structural building limits and multi-story accessibility challenges.

Accessible and special-focus centers: Bringing together neighborhood students into Sitton (a single-story school) and DLI students into César Chávez creates fully accessible, focused centers.

This is a proposal, not a final decision.

What is being proposed?

James John would close as a school building. Neighborhood K-5 students would move to Sitton K-5. Spanish Dual Language Immersion (DLI) students would move to César Chávez K-5.

What could students gain?

100% accessible school: Sitton’s single-story layout provides improved physical accessibility for all students compared to James John.
Concentrated DLI center: DLI students join a focused regional Spanish language center at César Chávez.

What else was considered?

Shared support services: Both James John and Sitton offer support for students with and without disabilities, SUN school and community support programs, and on-site food pantries.

What about special education?

As an Inclusive Community School, James John has led significant work to support all students with disabilities in their neighborhood school. As James John joins with Sitton—also an Inclusive Community School—that foundation will carry forward as the two communities unite into one Inclusive Community School. Portland Public Schools will maintain the complete continuum of Special Education services throughout the rightsizing process. We remain fully committed to delivering all IEP-determined programming and supports for every student.
To ensure a seamless transition, school and district leaders will conduct site walk-throughs to evaluate programmatic readiness, space, transportation, and ADA accessibility. Special education administrators will work closely with school principals to ensure every site is prepared to meet student IEP requirements.

JAMES JOHN

ENROLLMENT, PROGRAMS & MAPS

How many students are expected?

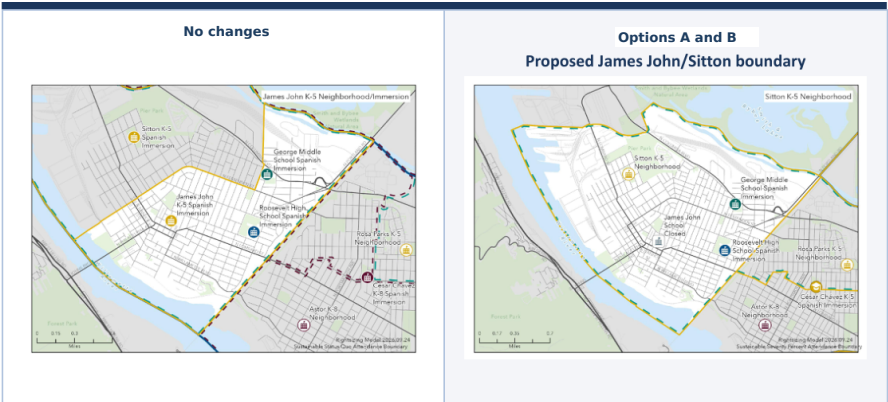
School year	2027-28	2028-29	2029-30	2030-31	2031-32
No changes	359	366	369	354	352

Options A and B: The James John facility closes. The James John community joins with the Sitton community.

Programs, school size & nearby families

Measure	No changes	Options A and B
Type of change	No changes	School would close
Meets school size goal?	No	School would close
Meets space use goal?	Yes	School would close
Students living within 1 mile	70.9%	School would close
Grades and programs	K-5 neighborhood/language immersion	School would close

Where would the school boundary be?



Who would the school serve?

Option	Poverty	Special education	Multilingual services	Underserved racial groups	Title I
No changes	54.5%	19.2%	26.6%	63.8%	Yes

Scenarios A and B: School would close